José I. **Kempff Seleme**

contact

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languages

Spanish (Native)

English (C1)

German (B2)

education

University College London
The Bartlett School of Architecture
London, United Kingdom

MSc in Architectural Computation
(2025 – 2026)

Master's Thesis: "Scoring the Sky: Zoning, Daylight, and the Design Spaces of Midtown Manhattan"

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya
Barcelona, Spain

Postgraduate in BIM for Modelling, Calculation and Simulation
(2024)

Universidad Politécnica de Madrid
ETSAM
Madrid, Spain

Master of Architecture
(2022 – 2023)

Master's Thesis: "SÚPER M.A.N. – Un nuevo paradigma de museo arqueológico"

https://oa.upm.es/76075/

BSc in Foundations of Architecture
(2015 – 2022)

Bachelor's Thesis: "La arquitectura y su contexto gráfico: Procesos de digitalización"

https://oa.upm.es/72669/

Technische Universität München
Munich, Germany

Erasmus+ Exchange Programme
(2020 – 2021)

Deutsche Schule Santa Cruz
Santa Cruz de la Sierra, Bolivia

International Baccalaureate Diploma
(2013 – 2014)

High School Diploma
(2002 – 2014)

summary

Licensed architect (ETSAM) at Foster + Partners, Madrid, focused on parametric design and BIM coordination for international projects. MSc in Architectural Computation at the Bartlett, UCL, awarded the Alasdair Turner Prize for the thesis. Experience spans large-scale mixed-use, cultural, industrial and data-centre buildings, combining parametric and generative design with machine-learning and LLM-based design workflows.

Particular interest in construction innovation, from BIM to Design for Manufacturing and Assembly (DfMA), and in the tools that support it: author of Mite, an open-source Grasshopper plugin published on Food4Rhino and selected for the XERJ Corpus Hub. Committed to teaching, having mentored over 25 M.Arch students at Miautics and coordinating the AI Simulation module at the MIAWS master (ETSAM, UPM).

experience

Foster + Partners – Madrid, Spain

- **Architect** – FULL-TIME NOV 2026 – PRESENT

Focus on parametric design, modelling and BIM coordination for international projects, contributing to large-scale mixed-use and cultural buildings from concept to detailed design.

Develop parametric tools for design optimisation and detailing, from overall geometry to façade systems, using Rhino, Grasshopper, scripting and Revit, alongside the practice's in-house tools for AI and analysis.

Collaborate with multidisciplinary teams across the Madrid and London studios, integrating computational design workflows into project delivery.

Miautics – Madrid, Spain

- **Computational Design Specialist** – FREELANCE DEC 2023 – OCT 2026

Mentored 25+ M.Arch students and professionals in their design projects.

Supported client projects from concept to detailing, developing computational workflows and advanced modelling.

Contributed to the educational platform for the generation, production and representation of architectural projects, investigating how computational methods should be introduced to students.

Sener – Madrid, Spain

- **Structural BIM Architect** – FULL-TIME FEB 2025 – SEP 2025

Developed national and international data-centre projects within multidisciplinary teams, working across RIBA stages 2, 3, and 4 using BIM-based workflows.

Coordinated and managed structural BIM models through the Autodesk Construction Cloud (ACC), ensuring consistency, accuracy, and effective collaboration across disciplines.

Consolidated and optimised established internal BIM workflows, while also proposing and developing new workflow initiatives to improve efficiency and model reliability.

Supported structural and mechanical calculations, translating analytical outputs into coordinated BIM models suitable for design development and construction documentation, applying in-depth knowledge of Spanish and European structural regulations (CTE) to both metallic and concrete structures, including in-situ and precast systems.

Ingeser – Madrid, Spain

- **BIM Architect** – FULL-TIME FEB 2024 – OCT 2024

Coordinated and developed a wide range of national and international buildings for offices, industrial plants (e.g. food, pharmaceutical) and logistics within the BIM scheme using Revit and specific plug-ins and add-ons, along with the Autodesk suite.

Reviewed third-party BIM and IFC models for quality control and clash detection. Improved and automated particular workflows.

Collaborated alongside the Engineering Department in different project stages, from schematic to detail design, plus construction documents and building permits.

Applied knowledge of Spanish and European accessibility, fire safety, structural safety and urban regulations.

Ensamble Studio – Madrid, Spain

- **Architectural Intern** – INTERNSHIP OCT 2023 – DEC 2023

Trained in on-site construction on the studio's extension building.

Managed the building team applying lean principles, reducing time and effort by 32%.

recognitions

Alasdair Turner Prize 2025–26 for the master's thesis at The Bartlett School of Architecture

Honours in Soil Mechanics at ETSAM and top marks in three courses at TUM

Exhibition of Final Bachelor Project in *Matadero* (Madrid), as part of the ETSAM Show, 2022

Rotary Club Prize for best student in High School, 2014

Second best student (salutatorian) of the class of 2014 in the German School

tools

Computational Design and Programming:

- Rhinoceros
  - Grasshopper
- Visual Studio Code, GitHub
- Mite (author)

BIM and Digital Construction:

- Revit
  - Dynamo
- AutoCAD
- Autodesk Construction Cloud (ACC)
- Vehicle Tracking

Structural, Environmental and Analysis:

- Karamba
- IDEA StatiCa
- Robot Structural Analysis
- Ladybug
- Kangaroo
- CYPE, CYPECAD (Spain)

AI and Automation:

- LLMs (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)
- ComfyUI
- RhinoMCP

Visualisation and Media:

- Blender
- Twinmotion, D5 Render, Enscape, Lumion
- Adobe Creative Cloud (Ps, Ai, Id, Ae, Pr)

GIS and Data:

- QGIS
- ArcGIS

programming

C#
Python

skills

Computational and Algorithmic Design:

Development of advanced parametric and rule-based design systems

Algorithmic modelling across multiple architectural and structural scales

Data-driven workflows integrating geometry, performance, and fabrication logic

BIM and Digital Construction:

BIM coordination, model authoring, and quality control across design and construction stages

Development and optimisation of BIM workflows for multidisciplinary collaboration

Translation of analytical and engineering outputs into coordinated BIM models

Structural, Environmental and Performance Analysis:

Structural and bioclimatic analysis using numerical and algorithmic methods

Application of finite element analysis, ray tracing, and performance-based evaluation

Integration of analysis results into design and construction documentation

AI, Automation and Computational Workflows:

Exploration and application of generative AI and LLM-based methods in architectural workflows

Automation of repetitive processes and optimisation of digital pipelines

Critical assessment and implementation of emerging computational technologies

Communication and Visualisation:

Clear graphic representation of complex design and technical information

Visual storytelling for design development and client communication

Professional and Interpersonal:

Team leadership and representation, from managing an on-site building team to leading student representation

Mentoring and teaching of computational methods to students and professionals

Coordination with clients, consultants and engineering teams

Research-driven problem solving, from academic investigation to tool development in practice

courses

Python for Structural Engineers — 2026
Led by Timo Harboe Zollner (pythonforstructuralengineers.com)

Design Workflows (*FTP*) with Grasshopper — 2023
Course from Miautics (OFFMIAU), led by Álvaro Sánchez Garda

Intermediate Visual Programming (*PVI*) with Grasshopper — 2019
Course from Miautics (OFFMIAU), led by Sergio del Castillo

Basic Visual Programming (*PVB*) with Grasshopper — 2018
Course from Miautics (OFFMIAU), led by Sergio del Castillo

extracurriculars

Lead Representative of the Bartlett School of Architecture, UCL	2025 – 2026
Student Representative of the MSc Architectural Computation at UCL	2025 – 2026
Multiple times elected as class delegate at ETSAM	2016 – 2022
Erasmus Buddy for incoming international students at ETSAM	2022
Student Representative on the ETSAM Council	2018
Model UN delegate, awarded the excellence prize	2012 – 2014
Volunteer work (200h) for various NGOs in Bolivia	2012 – 2013

references

Taba Rasti (trasti@fosterandpartners.com)
Martha Tsigkari (m.tsigkari@ucl.ac.uk)
Javier Francisco Raposo Grau (*javierfrancisco.raposo@upm.es*)
Víctor Navarro Ríos (*victor@langarita-navarro.com*)
Sergio del Castillo Tello (*miautics@miautics.com*)
Antón García-Abril (*anton@ensamble.com*)